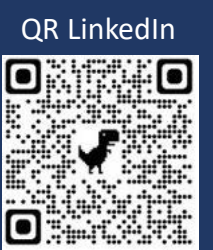


TOWARDS INQUIRY BASED AESTHETIC-ASSESSMENT OF RESONANT-WRITING FOR WOMEN WITH CANCER



Wassim.Mahfouz@tu-ilmenau.de

Wassim Mahfouz

Studio for Art-therapy Oriented Reengineering, Voluntary Community, Germany.

Introduction & Research Question

This work-in-progress poster reports about a research-based design-project managed by a community of volunteer coworkers interested in supporting German and migrant-women with cancer. The community is clarified in Fig. 1, and its research is driven by the question:

- How **Resonant-Writing (RW)** by co-workers in Fig. 1 can be designed and aesthetically assessed to approach alienation phenomena in co-working spaces to support German and migrant women with cancer?

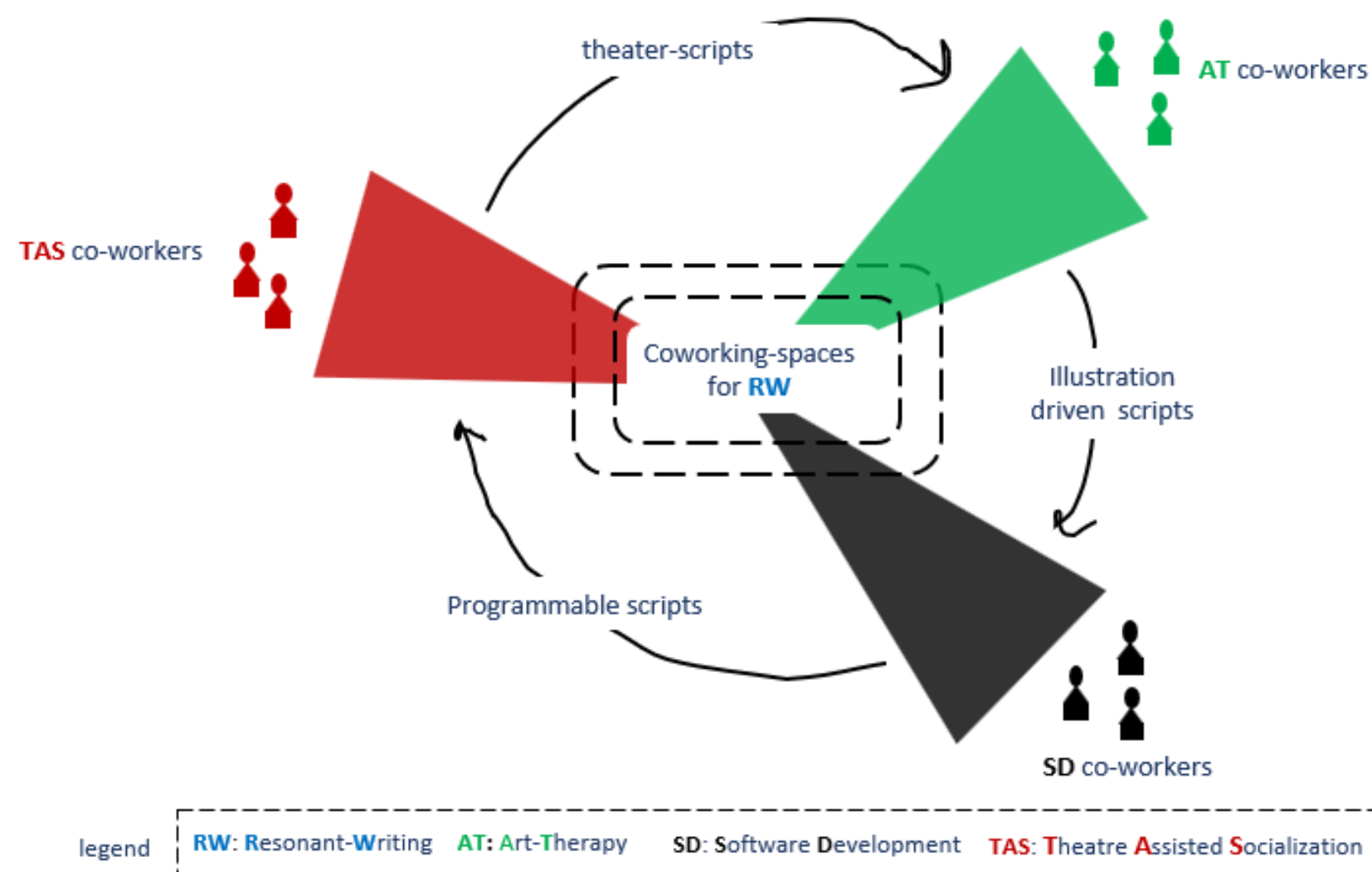


Fig 1. Workshops as coworking spaces to research and experiment resonant-writing.

RW is an experimental workflow for producing **RW** scripts by the co-workers (see Fig. 1). The workflow is driven by the assumption that producing a **RW** script can consist of, at least, one or more of the sub-scripts. The sub-scripts are illustration driven scripts, programmable scripts and theater scripts (see Fig. 1). Finally, the workflow's experimental and research challenges are summarized in next section.

Research Challenges

The research challenges can be formulated as it follows:

- What are good "**RW** scripts" to serve social and nursing care for women with cancer?
 - If women are migrants, how the writers of the **RW** scripts can understand their pre-migration cultures and their aesthetic values?
- How "aesthetic-assessment methods" can be designed to capture the good-quality of producing "**RW** scripts"

Towards Inquiry-Based Aesthetic-Assessment of RW

Fig. 2 shows in big picture our innovative design-approach towards inquiry based **RW** aesthetic-assessment. It shows how the design-approach is conceptualized to enable researching how to integrate the design theorist Christopher Alexander's views on "living-structures1"[A02] & "inner beauty" and the sociologist Hartmut Rosa's theory of "resonance" [R19] to approach alienation [R13] phenomena in social-spaces

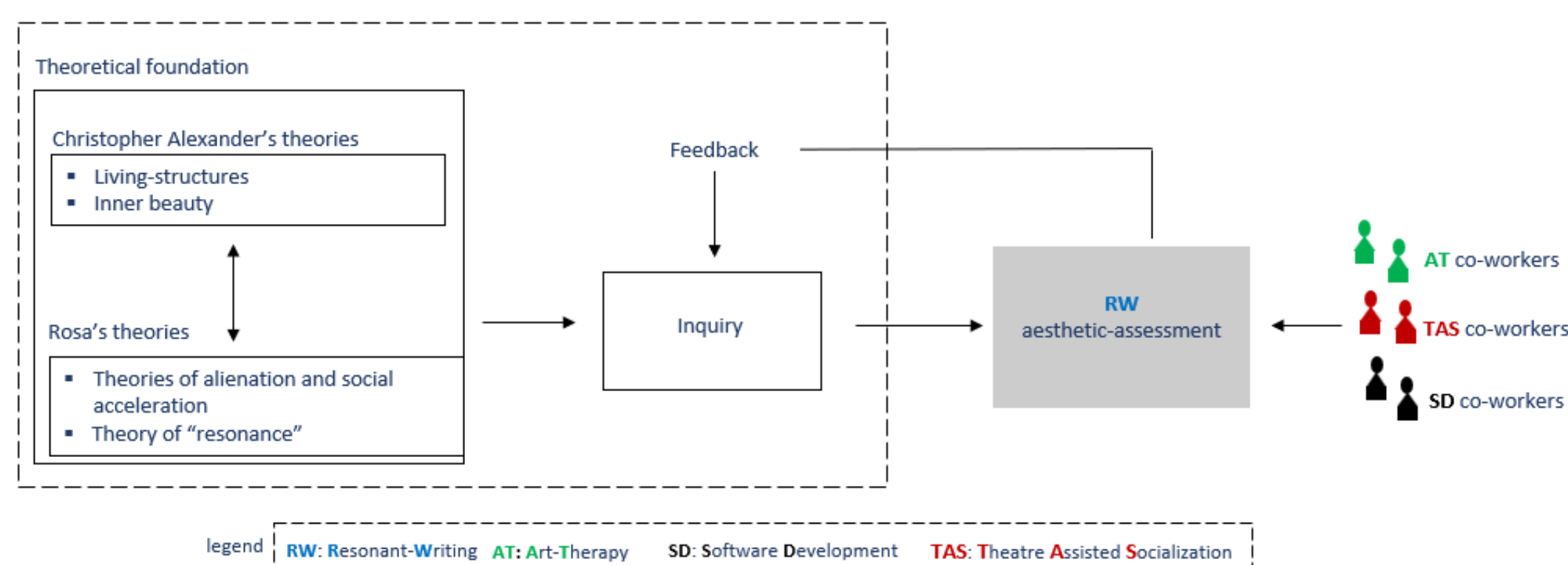


Fig 2. Design-approach towards inquiry based RW aesthetic-assessment.

The co-workers in Fig. 2 have suggested to look at aesthetic-assessments in a digital culture as form of Formative eAssessment (FA) activities. To understand the FA state-of-research and state-of-practice our works in [MW19, MW21, MW22a, MW22b, MWW23, M24, M25] might be helpful to co-workers in Fig. 2.

Initial Inquiry Results & Future Works

The initial inquiry is about how to design an illustration driven script (see Fig. 1) for a Syrian migrant woman. The script should be designed as 5 minutes film format that helps the woman tell her life experiences and cancer-experiences as aesthetic-illustration driven story. This aesthetic-illustration driven story is planned to be presented in our future works. In this work-in-progress paper, we can present few aesthetic-illustrations of this story. The illustrations and their short explanations are presented in Figs 3 and 4.



Fig 3. To help the Syrian woman after many operations to prevent the cancer development, this illustration was produced by Mr. Gerhard Eichinger, an artist friend of the woman family.



Fig 4. To help the Syrian woman in cancer tell her story in aesthetic way, an aesthetic workshop was organized with her. As outcome of this workshop, she was able with one of her family members to produce this stone sculpture. The sculpture has a stone stair, and a statement in German language "Fragentreppe zum Freien Willen". In English it means "Questions ladder for free will".

Finally, for experimenting aesthetic ways of writing and acting **RW** scripts, how to integrate Augusto Boal's works "aesthetics of the oppressed" in our suggested design approach is one of our research future questions.

References

- [A02] C. Alexander; The phenomenon of life: The nature of order, book 1. Oxford University Press (2002)
- [R19] H. Rosa; Resonance: A Sociology of Our Relationship to the World, trans. James C. Wagner (Cambridge: Polity, 2019).
- [R13] H. Rosa; Alienation and acceleration: Towards a critical theory of late-modern temporality, NSU Press (2013)
- [MW19] W. Mahfouz and H. -D. Wuttke, "Automatic Classifiers for Formative Assessment," IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), Covington, KY, USA, 2019, pp. 1-9, doi: 10.1109/FIE43999.2019.9028713.
- [MW21] W. Mahfouz and H. -D. Wuttke, "Big Data Analytics APIs Architecture for Formative Assessors," IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), Lincoln, NE, USA, 2021, pp. 1-9, doi: 10.1109/FIE49875.2021.9637431.
- [MW22a] W. Mahfouz and H. -D. Wuttke, "Deep-learning API-feature Specification Tool for Formative Assessment in Workshops," IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), Uppsala, Sweden, 2022, pp. 1-9, doi: 10.1109/FIE56618.2022.9962474.
- [MW22b] W. Mahfouz, H.D. Wuttke; Integrating Flow Theory in Freirean Pedagogy Based Workshops for Formative Assessment, 2022, ICERI2022 Proceedings, pp. 6299-6309
- [MWW23] W. Mahfouz, H. -D. Wuttke and S. Werner, "Formative-Assessment Freirean-Dialogue API for Data-Analytics Trainee-Teachers," 2023 IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), College Station, TX, USA, 2023, pp. 1-5, doi: 10.1109/FIE5773.2023.10342969. (2023)
- [MW23] W. Mahfouz and H. -D. Wuttke, Towards Deep-learning Text Classifiers for Formative Assessment Diagnostics, Poster in 2023 IEEE Frontiers in Education Conference (FIE), College Station, TX, USA, 2023.
- [M24] W. Mahfouz; DIFFUSION-MODELS AS INPAINTING INQUIRIES FOR EXPRESSIVE-ART BASED FORMATIVE-ASSESSMENT, 2024, ICERI2024 Proceedings, pp. 4983-4992.
- [M25] W. Mahfouz; CONCEPT OF UNCONSCIOUS-DEFORMATION ASSESSMENT FOR FORMATIVE E-ASSESSMENT DESIGNERS, 2025, ICERI2025 Proceedings.

Acknowledgements

We thank

- Mrs. Brigitte Höh for her art workshop support to produce the artwork in Fig.4. Her web site is: <https://www.atelier-kunstundtherapie.de/>
- Mr. Gerhard Eichinger for his voluntary artwork in Fig 3; His web site is: <https://gerhard-eichinger.de/>
- Ilmenau University of Technology <https://www.tu-ilmenau.de/>